



You can thank Radia Perlman for this

which was quickly adopted as the de facto standard for network bridging. She also created a computer terminal to handle traffic to and from massive interconnected networks. Radia made significant contributions towards the early advancement of the Internet and has over 80 patents in her name as a testimony of her groundbreaking work.

Without Perlman, we wouldn't have been able to share files or data connection packets over the rapidly expanding Internet in its early days. You didn't know that now, did you?

WIRELESS WONDERGIRL

Hedy Lamarr is credited with co-inventing a piece of technology that's still in use in mobile phone towers and Bluetooth and Wi-Fi networks to this day. Born in Austria, Lamarr went on to become a Hollywood heartthrob before altering the course of wireless technology forever

during World War II. How she ended up becoming a pioneer of a critical method of wireless data transmission isn't unlike a Hollywood flick in its own right.

In a conversation with inventor, author and composer, George Antheil in Los Angeles, from whom Lamarr was seeking tips on improving her figure, radio-controlled torpedoes somehow turned into a topic of discussion. Why? It seems Lamarr was somewhat of an expert on torpedoes due to meetings she attended with her former husband, and this is how she ended up collaborating with Antheil on frequency hopping, a technique used for rapidly switching between a number of frequencies in a synchronised manner. They patented their secret wireless communication technology in 1942, but it wasn't until after the war in the 1950s that Lamarr's co-invention resurfaced and became a cornerstone of private telecom operators' radio communication infrastructure.

TITAN OF TELEPHONY

Dr. Erna Hoover, an American mathematician born in 1926, is credited with creating a major impact on modern communication technology through computer soft-

ware. All this at a time when computers were still getting off their blocks.

While working at Bell Labs, Hoover devised an ingenious solution to tackle the volume of incoming telephone calls being received there. The solution required her to invent a computing method to handle telephone call switching instead of the hard-wired, mechanical switcher in use at the time. Her method took incoming call prioritisation efficiency to a never-before-imagined, unprecedented level – especially for calls during peak load times – allowing for a smooth, intelligent call switching process. And legend has it that Dr. Hoover came up with this innovative solution to the call-switching problem while giving birth to one of her three daughters in a hospital!

Dr. Hoover further has the distinction of being awarded one of the first computer software patents ever handed out to an inventor, male or female. It is no surprise then that her name is mentioned in the same breath as other revolutionary pioneers of computer technology.

MOTHER OF OBJECT-ORIENTED PROGRAMMING

As one of the first women to earn a PhD in computer science, Barbara Liskov has been a significant contributor in the world of computing innovations. Her path-breaking work paved the way for modern object-oriented programming (OOP) languages, which is an epic feat indeed.

How did Liskov help create OOP? By inventing what's known as the CLU, an early programming language that helped lay the foundation stone for object-oriented programming back when software engineers didn't exist. She also developed



Love Wi-Fi? Thank Hedy Lamarr

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